

02 TONE OF VOICE

Tone of Voice emerges from:

#1

What do we stand for & what is our Persona?

#2

How do we want our stakeholders to feel?

Tone of Voice impacts:

#1

Who are we speaking to?

#2

Where are we speaking to them?

How do we want our stakeholders to feel?

#1 **Heard – We understand their needs and challenges**

#2 **Reassured – We know what we're doing, and we deliver**

#3 **Unfettered – We're agile and responsive to change**

#4 **Inspired – We create measurable, meaningful results**

If we want our stakeholders to feel

#1 **Heard** – We understand their needs and challenges

#2 **Reassured** – We know what we're doing, and we deliver

#3 **Unfettered** – We're agile and responsive to your ambition

#4 **Inspired** – We create measurable, meaningful results

Then our Voice needs to be

#1 **Warmly Personal**

#2 **Knowledgeably Expert**

#3 **Infectiously Passionate**

#4 **Confidently Definitive**

How do we want to present ourselves?

	Potential		Proven Capability
CAPABILITY	Entrepreneurial <i>Experimental Innovators</i>	➔	Expert <i>Proven Mastery</i>
ORIENTATION	Beyond Horizon / Future-focused <i>Potential of tomorrow</i>	➔	Focus on Now <i>Measurable impact, today</i>
BELIEF	Bold Pusuer <i>Fearless pursuit of ambition</i>	➔	Makers of Possible <i>Grounded in evidence & experience</i>
RELATIONSHIP	Provider <i>Delivering solutions</i>	➔	Enduring Partnerships <i>Relationships beyond contract</i>
APPROACH	Optimistic <i>Fuelled by possibility and vision</i>	➔	Passionate <i>Make it infectious</i>
MEASURE OF SUCCESS	Promise-led <i>Intentful commitments</i>	➔	Performance First <i>Consistent delivery</i>

Tone of voice principle #1

Warmly Personal

We lead with good in our hearts

We (always were and) are genuine, human, and approachable, but never saccharine-sweet or overly emotional. We care deeply about our work and its impact, but we express this through authentic connection rather than sentimentality.

It feels:

Human, genuine, caring, authentic

It does not feel:

Saccharine-sweet, overly emotional, manipulative, distant, formal

How we show this in our writing:

- Write like a person, not like a corporation. Use "you" and "we" to create connection
- Use conversational language where appropriate
- Show empathy for challenges our customers face & be honest about complexities sans condescension
- Express care through action & results, beyond promises
- Use contractions to sound more natural

Tone of voice principle #2

Expert, yet Accessible

We bring energies together, of earth and people

We have deep knowledge and proven expertise. We use them always to clarify but never as a façade to hide behind. We make the complex simple and the technical understandable.

It feels:

Knowledgeable, clear, helpful, inclusive

It does not feel:

Condescending, overly technical, exclusive, simplistic

How we show this in our writing:

- Explain technical concepts in plain language by avoiding unnecessary jargon and acronyms
- Use examples & visualizations to illustrate complex ideas
- Show insights & expertise through what we've done, not just what we know
- Break down complex processes into clear steps

Tone of voice principle #3

Confidently Definitive, Now We make all of it work, today.

We're assured in our capabilities and proven track record, but we remain humble and collaborative. Our confidence comes from performance and results, not bluster.

It feels:

Assured, reliable, capable, grounded, finitely now

It does not feel:

Boastful, dismissive, overconfident, uncertain, apologetic

How we show this in our writing:

- Use the active voice to show ownership
- Make clear, direct statements backed by evidence
- Focus on results and impact today or in the finite future rather than superlatives and open-ended grand forecasts
- Acknowledge challenges while showing we can address them
- Avoid hedging language that undermines our authority ("maybe," "perhaps")
- Express clear & strong opinions on the issues that matter

Tone of voice principle #4

Infectiously Passionate

Our honest belief and passion overflows

We are driven by our passion and human energy. We wear it proudly too and it rubs-off on people. Because it's authentic and purposeful.

It feels:

Excited, involved, positive, perseverant, gritty.

It does not feel:

Nerdy, excluding, inwards, superior and pretentious

How we show this in our writing:

- Don't shy from showing honest emotions
- Detail the engagement interestingly.
- Appreciate wholeheartedness wholeheartedly
- Indicate the rigor crisply, provide references
- Cite alignment with similar passions
- Stand up for things that matter boldly

TOV Principles in sum & Key Vocabulary Shifts:

TOV Principles		Move Away From		Move Toward
#1	Warmly Personal	Tomorrow, future, vision	→	Today, now, current
		Revolutionary, transformative	→	Effective, proven, reliable
#2	Knowledgeably Expert	Journey, mission	→	Work, delivery, results
		Believe, hope, aspire	→	Know, deliver, achieve
#3	Infectiously Passionate	Green, sustainable (overuse)	→	Efficient, cost-effective, reliable
		Innovation (abstract)	→	Specific technologies and approaches
#4	Confidently Definitive	Partnership (vague)	→	Collaboration with specific outcomes